The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: October 2026 to date. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

October 2026 Incomplete October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Trades

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit · latest closed month: September

October is still in progress and wages are paid fortnightly, so a part month can't be bridged: this is September, the latest closed month. September's jobs made $96,230 gross margin (42.7%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $28,417 and overheads $59,580, leaving $8,233 profit before tax (3.7% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 39.0% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$96,230
Technician wages and on-costs	$79,587
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$51,170
Technician time not charged to jobs	$28,417
Gross profit (the P&L)	$67,813
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,580
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$8,233
Revenue	$225,460
Gross margin on jobs, %	42.7%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	3.7%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**39.0%**

Line: All

October so far against October last year **(40.1%)**
$86,031 against $143,566

Year to date against the same period last year
11.7%
$726,624 against $650,349

Gross margin, year to date
44.9%
$325,918 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is 11.7% up on the same period last year, year to date ($726,624 against $650,349). Maintenance contracts make the highest gross margin (63.9%); Installations the lowest (36.5%). The business needs 39.0% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 36.5% gross margin, 1.5 points over the 35.0% target ($6,565 ahead on $449,100 this financial year to date). Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($52,374 ahead on $181,400 this financial year to date).

Line: Maintenance contracts

October so far against October last year
13.1%
$45,350 against $40,100

Year to date against the same period last year
19.6%
$181,400 against $151,700

Gross margin, year to date
63.9%
$115,864 before overheads

What it shows

Maintenance contracts brought in $181,400 this financial year to date, 19.6% on the same period last year (faster than the business as a whole, 11.7%), at a 63.9% gross margin (above the 44.9% overall).

What you'd do about it

Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($52,374 ahead on $181,400 this financial year to date).

Line: Installations

October so far against October last year **(53.3%)**
$37,000 against $79,300

Year to date against the same period last year
9.0%
$449,100 against $412,100

Gross margin, year to date
36.5%
$163,750 before overheads

What it shows

Installations brought in $449,100 this financial year to date, 9.0% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 11.7%), at a 36.5% gross margin (below the 44.9% overall).

What you'd do about it

Installations: 36.5% gross margin, 1.5 points over the 35.0% target ($6,565 ahead on $449,100 this financial year to date).

Line: Call-outs and repairs

October so far against October last year **(84.8%)**
$3,681 against $24,166

Year to date against the same period last year
11.1%
$96,124 against $86,549

Gross margin, year to date
48.2%
$46,304 before overheads

What it shows

Call-outs and repairs brought in $96,124 this financial year to date, 11.1% on the same period last year (slower than the business as a whole, 11.7%), at a 48.2% gross margin (above the 44.9% overall).

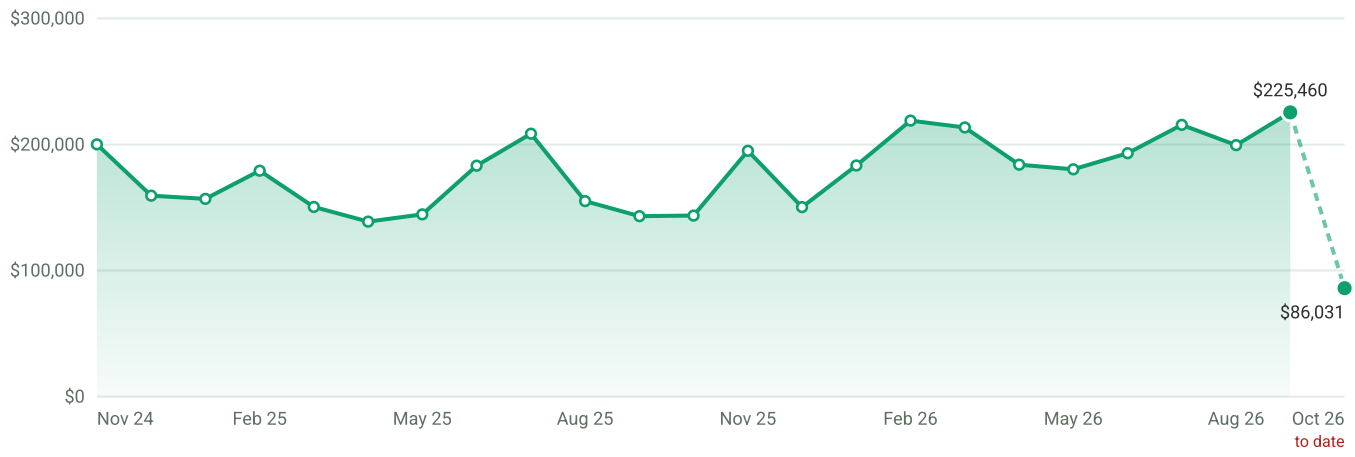
What you'd do about it

Call-outs and repairs: 48.2% gross margin, 13.2 points over the 35.0% target ($12,661 ahead on $96,124 this financial year to date).

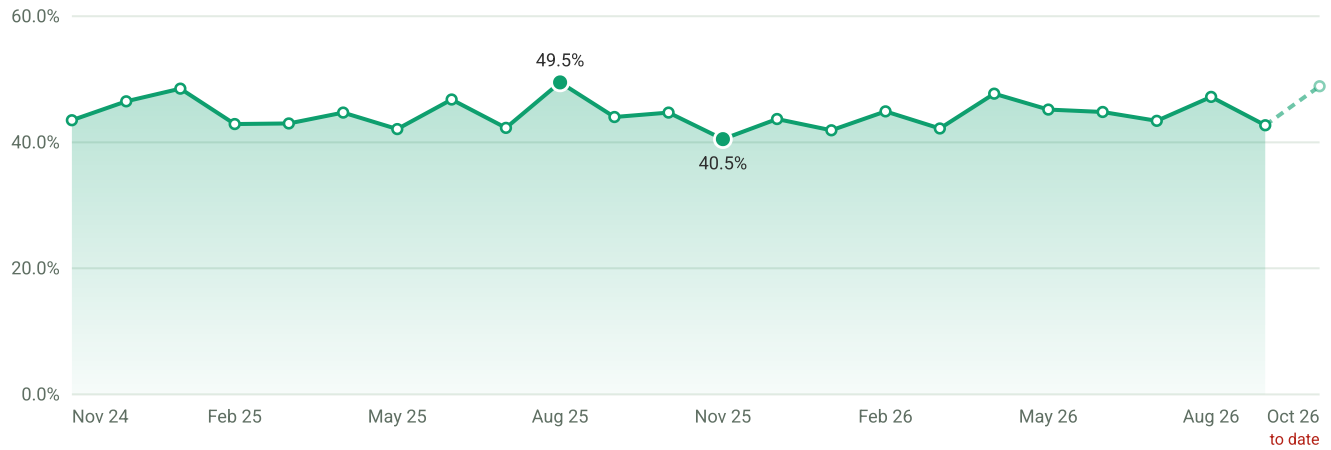
Every line at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by line, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By line: financial year to date (Jul to Oct 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Maintenance contracts	$181,400	$151,700	19.6%	$115,864	63.9%
Installations	$449,100	$412,100	9.0%	$163,750	36.5%
Call-outs and repairs	$96,124	$86,549	11.1%	$46,304	48.2%
Total	$726,624	$650,349	11.7%	$325,918	44.9%

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.